MOUSE -- Interview Prep

Duane Bastress

April 06, 2026

STORY ARC

Duane Bastress wrestled for McCollum at Bermudian Springs, winning the Mid-Penn tournament at 160 lbs. He went on to York College where he became a two-time NCAA Division III national champion (38-2 record, 184 lbs). As an assistant coach at York, he mentored Kyle Flickinger -- calling him 'a sponge' -- and helped him reach the NCAA D-II Championships. Bastress was nominated for the Adams County Sports Hall of Fame in 2011. He represents the full McCollum pipeline: wrestler, champion, coach, passing it forward.

QUESTIONS

1. You wrestled for McCollum at Bermudian, then went on to win two national championships at York. What did McCollum give you that made that possible?

Direct connection between the high school program and college success. Bastress is the clearest example of the McCollum pipeline.

2. An article from 2001 describes a wrestler who credited practicing with you, under McCollum's guidance, for his improvement. Were you aware of that role -- being the guy who made other wrestlers better in the room?

From the Mid-Penn title article. This is a McCollum philosophy question: the room makes the wrestler, not just the coach.

3. The night you won the D-III national title in 2005, McCollum's current team was at regionals. He told the paper: 'They all want to know how Duane is doing in the national finals. They want a national champ.' What was it like knowing those kids back in Bermudian were watching?

Beautiful detail -- Rickey Schmelyun was at regionals that same weekend, and the team was tracking Bastress's results. The program as a living organism.

4. 38-2 your junior year, national champion at 184. What was different about that season -- was it physical, mental, or something McCollum planted years earlier that finally clicked?

Gets at the long-term development question. Two NCAA titles doesn't happen by accident -- the origin story matters.

5. You coached Kyle Flickinger at York -- worked with him on lifting, conditioning, and what he called 'the mental edge.' You called him 'a sponge.' What did you see in him that reminded you of yourself at Bermudian?

From the 2007 Flickinger article. Connects two generations of the McCollum tree.

6. Flickinger said you pushed him, challenged him, stayed a step ahead of him in the wrestling room. Is that how McCollum trained you -- and were you consciously passing that down?

The article describes Bastress jogging ahead of Flickinger, pushing him. The coaching lineage question -- McCollum to Bastress to Flickinger.

7. You went from wrestling in McCollum's room to winning national titles to coaching the next generation. Looking at it now -- is what McCollum built at Bermudian Springs unusual, or is it just what good wrestling programs do?

The big-picture question. His answer defines whether the doc is about one special program or about wrestling culture more broadly.

8. If someone who's never watched a wrestling match asked you why a small-town program in Adams County, Pennsylvania matters -- what would you tell them?

The elevator pitch for the documentary, in Bastress's own words. He lived it as a wrestler, succeeded because of it, and passed it on as a coach.

SOURCE ARTICLES

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2000-12-31 -- Bermudian Springs Captures Team Trophy at Wrestling Meet
2001-01-14 -- Bermudian Springs Clinches Mid-Penn Commonwealth Division Title
2005-03-06 -- Bermudian Springs Claims NCAA National Wrestling Title
2007-02-28 -- Flickinger's Dedication Fuels NCAA Wrestling Success
2011-09-09 -- Fourteen Nominees for Adams County Sports Hall of Fame